

The logo consists of a dark blue square with the white letters "ML" inside.

Maket Lakay

A multi-vendor e-commerce marketplace built for Haiti and the Haitian diaspora — connecting local vendors to buyers at home and abroad.

CASE STUDY

MARKETPLACE / E-COMMERCE

PRE-LAUNCH — FOUNDATION COMPLETE

Executive Summary

Maket Lakay is a full-stack, multi-vendor marketplace purpose-built for Haiti's local merchants and the Haitian diaspora abroad. In roughly two weeks of focused engineering, the project moved from a static frontend prototype to a production-grade application with a real, secure backend covering the entire marketplace lifecycle — catalog, checkout, orders, delivery, vendor operations, disputes, and admin oversight.

The platform is live and deployed today. It is intentionally positioned at a specific, valuable milestone: **the technical foundation is complete and de-risked**, and the product is ready to onboard its first real vendors and customers. This case study documents what has been built, how it was built, and what remains before public launch.

24

DATABASE TABLES,
FULLY SECURED

30+

ENGINEERING
COMMITTS SHIPPED

~2

WEEKS FOUNDATION
TO PRODUCTION-
READY

3

ROLES: CUSTOMER,
VENDOR, ADMIN

Where things stand: the product is deployed and functional end-to-end, with zero real vendors onboarded yet. This is a deliberate, disciplined stage — every core workflow has been built and verified against real data before a single real merchant or shopper touches the platform.

The Opportunity

The gap

Haitian merchants — from artisans and food producers to small retailers — largely lack an accessible, trustworthy digital storefront tailored to their market. General-purpose global marketplaces are not built around Haiti-specific realities: local delivery logistics, regional payment methods (MonCash, NatCash) alongside international ones, bilingual/trilingual commerce (Kreyòl, French, English), and the strong economic bridge between Haiti and its diaspora communities abroad.

The bridge

The Haitian diaspora — concentrated in the United States, Canada, and France — maintains deep, active economic ties to Haiti, regularly sending goods, gifts, and support home. A marketplace that lets diaspora buyers purchase directly from Haitian vendors, with delivery handled locally, turns an informal, ad-hoc pattern into a structured commercial channel — for everyday goods, not just remittances.

Why now

- Mobile-first internet access continues to expand across Haiti, growing the addressable base of both shoppers and small merchants who can participate in digital commerce.
- Local payment rails (MonCash, NatCash) are already in wide everyday use, lowering the trust barrier for local transactions.
- No dominant, trusted, Haiti-specific multi-vendor marketplace currently exists — the category is open.

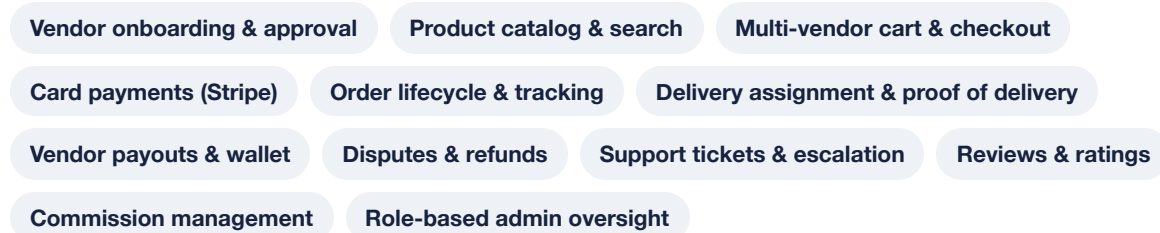
Market-sizing figures (addressable users, transaction volume, etc.) intentionally omitted here pending current, sourced data — to be added with verified figures before external distribution.

The Product

Three purpose-built experiences, one shared marketplace.

ROLE	WHAT THEY CAN DO
Customer	Browse by category, search, wishlist, multi-vendor cart, checkout (card via Stripe, plus local methods), saved addresses, order tracking with a real delivery timeline, product/store reviews, support tickets, dispute & refund requests.
Vendor	Apply and get approved into a real store; manage products & inventory; fulfill orders through the full delivery lifecycle (assign courier → picked up → in transit → delivered, with proof of delivery); run promotions; request payouts from a live, derived wallet balance; respond to disputes and support tickets for their store.
Admin / Support	Approve vendor applications; manage users, orders, and the product catalog; configure delivery zones and commission rates; resolve disputes, refunds, and support-ticket escalations; oversee payouts; view marketplace-wide reporting.

Core workflows already live



Technical Foundation

The engineering choice that matters most for a marketplace: every workflow above is backed by a real, secured database — not a demo.

Modern, proven stack

Next.js (React) frontend, TypeScript throughout, Supabase (Postgres) for the database and authentication, Stripe for card payments. All widely-adopted, well-supported technology — no exotic dependencies that create long-term risk.

Built for real operations, not a demo

Every feature listed on the previous page was verified end-to-end against the live database with real accounts before being considered done — not just checked to "look right" in the UI.

Security by default

Row Level Security is enabled on all 24 database tables. A customer can only ever see their own data; a vendor can only see and act on their own store's data; admin/support access is explicitly scoped by role. This is enforced at the database layer, not just in application code.

Deployed & continuously delivered

The application auto-deploys to production on every merge, with type-checking, linting, and a full production build required to pass before any change ships.

Engineering velocity

The backend — spanning identity, catalog, orders, payments, delivery operations, vendor commerce, and the full support/dispute lifecycle — was designed, built, secured, and verified in roughly two weeks of focused, disciplined engineering. This pace, combined with the verification discipline described above, is a meaningful signal of execution capability for whoever takes this platform to launch and beyond.

Current Status & Path to Launch

The platform is deployed and fully functional. What remains before public launch is deliberately narrow — business and operational readiness, not core engineering.

DONE

End-to-end marketplace platform

Catalog, checkout, orders, delivery, vendor operations, disputes/support, and admin oversight are all live against a real, secured backend.

NEXT

Activate real card payments

The Stripe integration is fully built; it activates as soon as live API keys are connected — a business step, not an engineering one.

NEXT

Onboard first vendors

The application-and-approval flow is live today; the platform is ready to bring on its first real merchants.

BEFORE PUBLIC LAUNCH

Production email delivery

A production-grade email provider is needed to re-enable account email confirmation at scale.

BEFORE PUBLIC LAUNCH

Kreyòl & French localization

The interface is structured to support Kreyòl and French; translation and activation is planned ahead of a full public launch.

Summary

Maket Lakay retires the hardest, riskiest part of building a marketplace — a secure, complete, real backend covering every stakeholder in the transaction — before spending a dollar on acquiring vendors or customers.

What's being sought now is a partner to help take this from a technically complete, deployed platform to a live marketplace with real vendors and real transaction volume: go-to-market execution, vendor recruitment, local operations, and/or capital to fund that growth phase.

This document is a snapshot of engineering and product status as of August 2026. Financial projections, market-sizing data, and a formal terms discussion are available on request.